

Philipp Hilbert. *Trading PM for a platform where execution quality is the product.*

Positioning, fintech operator with 13 years of cross-functional delivery, a live backtesting engine and active perpetuals trading, joining the team that defines what FundedNext's brokerage experience feels like.

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§ WHY NEXT VENTURES

FundedNext's model is structurally interesting: the capital risk sits with the platform, which means every friction point in the trader's journey is a direct cost to the business, not just a UX complaint. That alignment between product quality and P&L is exactly the environment where rigorous discovery and fast iteration compound. The explicit mention of MT5 and cTrader integration caught my attention, platform connectivity is where spec ambiguity quietly destroys launch timelines, and I have managed that class of integration problem in regulated contexts before. I also actively trade perpetual futures on Hyperliquid and route spot orders through Jupiter and 1inch, so I arrive with a user's intuition for latency, slippage, and order-type UX already formed. *That operational fluency is hard to build in the seat and tends to show up fast in discovery sessions.*

§ HONEST FRAMING

My career has been in enterprise SaaS, public-sector analytics, insurance, and defence, not in retail trading platforms or prop-firm infrastructure specifically. The gap is institutional: I have not previously owned a product that sits between a trader's terminal and a risk engine. What I do bring is a strong pattern match: I have shipped payment-flow products in regulated environments, owned backlog prioritisation in compliance-heavy teams, and built the

mechanical intuition for how execution systems behave from years of hands-on trading and microstructure analysis.

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo refactors and spec generation
 - **GitHub Copilot**, paired coding with engineering
 - **Cursor**, editor-level AI assistance across Python and SQL
 - **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping for discovery artefacts
 - **Framer**, design-heavy mockups for stakeholder walkthroughs
 - **GPT**, requirement drafting, edge-case enumeration, user-story expansion
 - **n8n**, agentic workflow orchestration and automation pipelines
 - **Gamma.app**, structured presentation of roadmap and strategy materials
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§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

REST APIs, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), Django, Kubernetes, ArgoCD, Docker, GitOps, Jenkins, CI/CD pipelines, Dagster, dbt, ETL pipelines, Kafka, Git, GitLab, Azure DevOps, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

§ SIDE PROJECT

PHOENIX882, [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

A personal backtesting engine for crypto trading strategies.

- Reconstructs historical order-book conditions across centralised and decentralised venues for strategy validation.
- Built on a Python pipeline with DuckDB for fast local aggregation over tick-level data.
- Companion to Hyperion, an aFRR balancing-market pipeline that reconstructs marginal prices over merit-order data.
- Directly relevant to FundedNext: understanding how execution quality is measured is the prerequisite for specifying it as a product requirement.

§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT NEXT VENTURES

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow the operations and support teams handling platform escalations, sit in on MT5 and cTrader incident reviews, and map the current trader journey end-to-end, from account funding through challenge execution to payout, noting every handoff that is manual or opaque.

WEEK 2

Instrument and slice.

Define a short list of measurable success metrics for the three highest-friction points identified in week one, then slice the backlog against those metrics to find what is being built that does not move any of them.

WEEK 3+

Ship, close loops.

Lead the first sprint cycle with properly formed acceptance criteria and a compliance sign-off checkpoint baked in; establish a weekly rhythm of user-feedback synthesis with the support team so discovery is continuous rather than episodic.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Hiring Team at NEXT Ventures,

FundedNext's proposition is a structural bet: that the best way to grow a trading platform is to make losing the platform's problem, not the trader's. That bet only pays off if the product between the trader and their P&L is frictionless, trustworthy, and fast enough to disappear. Writing the specification for that product, across MT5, cTrader, and internal operations tooling, is the kind of work I want to do.

I bring 13 years of end-to-end product ownership in regulated environments: insurance claims infrastructure at EMIL Group, national labour-market analytics for the Federal Employment Agency, AI data platform delivery for the FCAS defence programme, and fintech from the earliest stage, I built Kvitt Payment Solutions from zero to acquisition by Sparkasse inside the girocard ecosystem. What these roles share is a recurring pattern: a cross-functional team, a

complex integration dependency, a compliance constraint, and a user who is paying attention to every second of latency. That is the pattern this role fits.

My engagement with crypto and trading markets is hands-on and infrastructure-oriented. I actively trade perpetuals on Hyperliquid, route spot orders through Jupiter and 1inch, and use Coinglass and Hyblock Capital for liquidation heatmap analysis and market structure work. I have built a personal backtesting engine (phoenix882) in Python and developed Hyperion, a pipeline reconstructing marginal prices over merit-order data for balancing-power markets. I am not describing interest, I am describing a daily practice that produces the kind of intuitions that make discovery interviews faster and acceptance criteria sharper.

On the technical side, the job description names API collaboration, database fluency, and AI literacy as requirements. I have owned platform integrations at the API level across healthcare (CGM KIS interface), public sector (Dagster and dbt data pipelines), and DevOps (GitOps rollout that cut deployment time from days to thirty minutes). I use Claude, GPT, and GitHub Copilot in my daily workflow, not as productivity shortcuts but as instruments for spec generation, edge-case enumeration, and rapid prototyping. I can distinguish a feasible agent integration from an impressive-sounding one because I have built several of each.

I am relocating to or available in Dubai, and I am prepared to work fully on-site. I would welcome the chance to talk through how my background maps to the specific product challenges FundedNext is working on right now.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Product manager with 13 years of end-to-end ownership in regulated, technically complex environments. I turn messy integration dependencies and compliance constraints into clear requirements, prioritised backlogs, and shipped product, without losing the cross-functional team in the process. For this role, the most directly transferable pattern is payment-flow and platform-integration PM work in regulated contexts, combined with hands-on trading and market-microstructure practice across centralised and decentralised venues.

§ WHAT I CAN DO

Product Ownership: user stories, acceptance criteria, backlog refinement, sprint planning, velocity tracking, UAT, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

Product Management: continuous discovery, product vision, roadmap, RICE and Kano prioritisation, MVP definition, A/B testing, user research, prototyping, go-to-market support.

Agile and Scaled Delivery: Scrum, Kanban, SAFe, ART, PI planning.

Fintech and Payments: P2P payment flow design, PSP integration, girocard ecosystem, regulatory alignment, compliance-first backlog triage.

AI Products and Tooling: LLM agent design, agentic workflow orchestration, prompt engineering, evaluation loops, human-in-the-loop design, EU AI Act, Explainable AI; Claude, GPT, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable.

Analytics and Data: KPI definition, funnel analysis, ETL, Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL, Matomo, MicroStrategy.

Technical Environments Owned: Kubernetes, ArgoCD, Docker, GitOps, Jenkins, CI/CD, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, Git, GitLab, Azure DevOps.

Governance: GDPR, Deputy IT Security Officer, identity management, budget ownership, ROI reasoning.

§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ · PRODUCT MANAGER · DEFENCE AI PLATFORM 2024 TO 2025

GitOps rollout with ArgoCD cut deployment from days to 30 minutes; redirected UI-led product to developer-first design after instrumentation showed zero adoption of the original flow. Stack: Kubernetes, ArgoCD, Helm, Python, GitLab.

BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT · PRODUCT MANAGER · PUBLIC ANALYTICS 2023 TO 2024

Introduced Dagster and dbt for automated quarterly data imports; migrated bare-metal system to containers; led full UI relaunch. Deputy IT Security Officer.

CLINET PLATFORMS · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE MOBILE 2023 TO 2023

Cut roadmap to top 10% of features, raising user acceptance fivefold; implemented CGM KIS interface personally, reducing digital anamnesis from 30 minutes to 5.

EMIL GROUP · PRODUCT MANAGER · INSURANCE B2B SAAS 2022 TO 2022

Restructured 18-person delivery org into three lean teams; shipped Claims Center from concept to production, reducing time-to-market for new insurance products from months to under a week.

SCHEIDT & BACHMANN · PRODUCT OWNER · RETAIL PAYMENTS 2021 TO 2022

POS and forecourt systems, SAFe setup with agile release trains and PI planning.

BUNDESDRUCKEREI · INTERIM PRODUCT OWNER · SECURE DATA 2021 TO 2021

Data structures and identity management for Robert Koch Institute programmes DIM and DESH.

AOK ITSCARE · PROXY PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTH INSURANCE 2019 TO 2020

Migrated legacy procurement system to Shopware for three AOK insurers and ~20,000 employees; still in production.

ENERCON · PROJECT LEAD · WIND ENERGY 2019 TO 2019

Full site IT modernisation end to end.

WALDBURG-ZEIL KLINIKEN · PRODUCT OWNER · CLINICAL NETWORK 2017 TO 2018

WLAN rollout across nine hospitals.

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

CONSTRUCT8 · FOUNDER AND PM · CONSTRUCTION STAFFING MARKETPLACE 2025 TO 2026

Zero to one: anonymity-until-payment two-sided marketplace on WhatsApp and Telegram, LLM agents across the funnel, solo operator.

QCRYPT AG · CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER · QUANTUM ENCRYPTION 2016 TO 2021

Shipped three-layer encryption product installing in under two minutes; later Chair of the board.

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS · FOUNDER AND CFO · FINTECH P2P
PAYMENTS 2013 TO 2018

Built from zero; acquired and operated by Sparkasse inside the girocard ecosystem.

SMART SOIL TECHNOLOGIES · CO-FOUNDER CDO/CFO · AGRITECH 2018 TO
2021

Took fertiliser product from laboratory to investor rounds; owned financial planning and investor reporting.

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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